

S till, since the tests, I had more questions than before. I sent a question sheet to ResMed and I got the following responses from **Dr Sibasish Dey**, Head of Medical Affairs, South Asia, ResMed.

Responses for Digit Magazine queries on OST

These responses are un-edited and came straight from the brand:

Q The OneSleepTest claims to diagnose sleep quality. Can you throw light on the studies and tests backing the claim? Also, could you please explain how the tech works?

A The OneSleepTest is one of the first steps for anyone with sleep disturbances to check whether they suffer from sleep apnea. It measures your heart rate, oxygen levels, and movement to provide a detailed and accurate picture of how you sleep.

Given that the product is USA FDA approved, we have conducted several clinical trials which resulted in being able to diagnose sleep apnea. In fact, the study An Evaluation of the NightOwl Home Sleep Apnea Testing System highlights the efficacy of OneSleepTest. OST is a test based on peripheral arterial tonometry technology to detect important parameters including heart rate, oxygen desaturation, and body movements to assess REM cycle and sleep apnea and as mentioned, it is a medical-grade device and not similar to the app used to track sleep.

Q Is the at-home sleep test as good as if not better than the in-lab test?

A The importance of sleep and how poor sleep can be an underlying cause of numerous health conditions are greatly underappreciated by individuals across the globe. Additionally, human beings are inclined to postpone visiting a physician out of fear of being diagnosed with a disease, although they may experience certain symptoms. Lastly and most importantly, many individuals are apprehensive about visiting hospitals, spending the night there, or even going into labs, which are a requirement for sleep tests. Therefore, keeping all these considerations in mind, we developed the at-home sleep test so that patients could assess, from the comfort of their homes, whether they have any sleep disturbances or are suffering from sleep apnea, one of the most widespread sleep-breathing disorders.

In terms of a home sleep test (HST) versus polysomnography (PSG), the latter offers a comprehensive view of all sleep disorders, while the former helps diagnose sleep apnea. More importantly, the cost of a PSG is expensive and can vary anywhere from INR 10,000 – INR 30,000, in comparison to the HST, is affordable, with the cost ranging between INR 2,500 – 4,000. Moreover, and most importantly, PSG requires the patient to sleep in the sleep laboratory or at a hospital, which is an unfamiliar environment, this could be uncomfortable for the individual, while with HST, the patient benefits from being able to complete the home sleep test in the convenience of their own home and bed.

Q Besides diagnosis, what other roles does a sleep specialist play?

A A sleep specialist is a doctor with a fellowship or certification in sleep medicine who specializes in treating sleep disorders such as insomnia, sleep apnea, and disorders of the sleep movements like sleepwalking. A sleep specialist will also have expertise in the field of pulmonology, psychiatry, ENT, or neurology. At ResMed, OneSleepTest data is analyzed by a sleep physician, who then presents the validated results with a thorough summary and treatment recommendations for the patient in accordance with the diagnosis.

Are there any potential side effects or risks associated with sleep tests? OneSleepTest is a simple, accurate and safe way to perform sleep apnea diagnosis in the comfort of your home and there are no risks or side effects associated with the device.

Q If somebody's diagnosed with sleep apnea or any other disorder, what's the further course of action? Do you offer treatments (in-lab polysomnography) or recommend places to get treatment?

A A sleep specialist shares the diagnosis in the OneSleepTest sleep report along with suggestions for the next steps. When an individual takes the OneSleepTest and is diagnosed with sleep apnea, it is advisable that the individual consult a sleep specialist to decide the best course of action for optimal healthcare. ResMed does not, however, provide polysomnography or suggest any specific locations or healthcare providers for treatment.

Read the complete interaction here - <https://digit.in/resmedone>

rate) from my Apple Watch Series 8 that I wore during the test and the results were pleasantly comparable. Also, since I am no medical expert, I had no option other than take their word for it. Was it

helpful? Yes, indeed! The thing is you have to be okay paying ₹2099 (mind you, that's with an offer) for this test and analysis (product and service). That could be a bit much for some, but again

you have the benefits of an in-home test here. So, in a way, you are paying the price for convenience too. And if you can sleep over that, you can track your sleep with this. **d**